Freddy Martinez

Chicago, IL - 773 672 0892

WORK EXPERIENCE

LUCY PARSONS LABS, Chicago, IL
Founder and Executive Director, October 2016 to Present

- Founded and lead a leading privacy and civil rights organization in Illinois.
- Obtained public records and published an exposé describing a secret Chicago Police Department budget used to obtain surveillance equipment.
- Exposed a warrantless cell-phone surveillance program deployed by the Chicago Police Department, leading to the passage of state legislation implementing warrant requirements.
- Organized a coalition of community groups to oppose a warrantless drone surveillance bill in the Illinois Senate.
- Lead trainings on public record requests for lawyers, journalists, and community groups.
- Acted as plaintiff in over forty FOIA litigation cases seeking improperly withheld public records.
- Lead numerous investigations into the use of ALPR technology over many years.

PROJECT ON GOVERNMENT OVERSIGHT, Washington, D.C.
Senior Researcher, August 2022 to November 2023

- Led POGO's work on warrantless surveillance including comprehensive reform to the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act.
- Published original reporting including on DHS's systemic mistreatment of migrants.
- Led internal trainings on software development for our reporters using Python.

OPEN THE GOVERNMENT, Washington, D.C.
Senior Policy Analyst, March 2019 to August 2022

- Publish original records, such as facial recognition technology covered in a front-page exposé of the *New York Times,* spawning numerous Congressional investigations and international regulatory action.
- Organize a coalition of experts to introduce comprehensive Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) reform in the 117th session of Congress.
- Analyze trends in federal FOIA legislation and litigation, implementation by federal agencies, and challenges faced by record requesters.
- Research, publish, and present on emerging technologies used in policing, immigration, technology, and surveillance.

FREEDOM OF THE PRESS FOUNDATION, San Francisco, CA
Mozilla / Ford Open Web Fellow, September 2017 to August 2018

- Completed a fellowship at the Freedom of the Press Foundation to protect and advance public-interest journalism and First-Amendment freedoms.
- Assisted newsrooms in installing the anonymous whistleblowing platform SecureDrop.

EXPEDIA, Chicago, IL
Software Developer, November 2016 to September 2017

- Collaborated with infrastructure and platform team to securely migrate to Amazon Web Services.
- Supported internal teams as the primary escalation point for legacy systems.

ORBITZ, Chicago, IL
Linux Systems Administrator II, July 2015 to November 2016

- Promoted internally to train new employees on corporate platforms.
- Developed and maintained internal tools in the bash and Python programming languages.
- Monitoring internal databases, deployments, and website health using automated and manual tools.

ORC SOFTWARE, Chicago, IL
Systems Administrator, April 2013 to July 2015
- Debugged trading strategies and trades with sub-second precision in multiple programming languages.

STERLING TRADER, Chicago, IL
Software Support, September 2011 to April 2013
- Provided technical support to financial firms and individual traders on high-frequency trading platform.
- Assisted programming team in writing software samples in multiple programming languages.

PUBLICATIONS

Up Against the Firewall. XRDS. https://xrds.acm.org/article.cfm?aid=3665595

ICE Kidnapped My Neighbor in Broad Daylight. The Aftermath Left Me Reeling. *Truthout. https://truthout.org/articles/ice-kidnapped-my-neighbor-in-broad-daylight-the-aftermath-left-me-reeling/*

The Mar-A-Lago Raid Highlights the DOJ's Hypocrisy on the Espionage Act. *Project on Government Oversight. https://www.thenation.com/article/politics/doj-trump-espionage-act/*

DHS's Secret Reports on ICE Detention. *Project on Government Oversight. https://www.pogo.org/investigates/dhss-secret-reports-on-ice-detention*

Police Quietly Obtain Private Location Data with a Checkbook and not a Warrant. *Project on Government Oversight. https://www.pogo.org/analyses/police-quietly-obtain-private-location-data-with-a-checkbook-and-not-a-warrant*

Documents: ICE, CBP Seize Billions in Assets, Including Human Remains. *Splinter News. Archived at, https://web.archive.org/web/20260425044202/https://www.jezebel.com/documents-ice-cbp-seize-billions-in-assets-including-1831181924*

Groups Fight Huge Expansion of Police Drone Monitoring of Protests. *Chicago Reader. https://chicagoreader.com/news/groups-fight-huge-expansion-of-police-drone-monitoring-of-protests/*

Inside the Chicago Police Department's Secret Budget. *Chicago Reader. https://chicagoreader.com/news/inside-the-chicago-police-departments-secret-budget/*

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

Former Board Member, *Library Freedom Project*
Advisory Board Member, *Distributed Denial of Secrets*
Board Member, *MuckRock*

EDUCATION

Creighton University, Omaha, NE
Completed 18 hours of coursework towards a Masters in Physics, August 2011

Monmouth College, Monmouth, IL
Bachelor of Arts in Physics, September 2009